that drew a sharp distinction between the State and the Hindu religious and cultural identity.

The Jan Sangh was created in 1951 for precisely this purpose: to politically oppose the Nehruvian idea of India. As the BJP's Home Minister Amit Shah describes it, 'When under Nehru ji India's development, agricultural, foreign, defence and education policies were being created, then [Jan Sangh founder] Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee and several people like him felt that if the country goes on the path of the policies being developed by the Nehru government then it won't even find the way to turn back.' The alternative they presented had, in the BJP's view, the 'smell of the soil of this nation' as opposed to the 'pungent smell of Western thinking' that it believes Nehru represented.[11]

This ideological counterpoint proved politically unwinnable in Indian elections for years. Yet, its driving impulse was clear. In Shah's words, there was a 'big fundamental difference' between the ideology of the Congress and the Jan Sangh: Nehru's Congress wanted to build a 'new India [navnirman] whereas the Bharatiya Jan Sangh wanted to use its *ancient cultural heritage* and majestic splendour as the basis to *completely rebuild* [punarnirman] India' (emphasis added). It was to present this 'alternative thinking' that the Jan Sangh was 'born under Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee which is now in front of the nation in the form of the Bharatiya Janata Party'.[12]

It took over seven decades for this alternative to become electorally acceptable on a national scale. This book shows how the shift in the BJP's political fortunes occurred, what changed, what it started doing differently, and the strategies that powered this change. It unpicks how a fundamentally reshaped BJP, under Narendra Modi, built on the advances of previous years but significantly reordered itself using digital technologies and revamped internal management practices to drive this growth. It uses fresh empirical evidence to demonstrate how the new BJP built novel caste alliances, reshaped class relations, tapped into gender structures and developed a new targeted politics of welfare within an India searing with religious tensions. These changes transformed the BJP into the primary pole of Indian politics as well as the world's largest political party.